Adding a Referral

BCBS AR · Case Manager Reference

BEFORE YOU START

Members have one 20-hour allotment per benefit year to split across Post-Discharge and Virtual Companion, however they need it. Another discharge in the same year doesn't create another allotment. Not every member uses both services — only add what's actually needed.

ONLY CREATE THESE TWO REFERRALS

You may see an Initial IHS Assessment tile with its own Add Referral button. Leave it alone — the Helper Bees team creates the assessment referral and assigns the provider once your post-discharge referral comes in. It's a separate one-point benefit and doesn't use any of the 20 hours.

Create the referral

1. From the member's Post Discharge Support benefit page, select Add Referral.
2. Choose Service Category: In Home Support.
3. Search for and select the service: Post Discharge or Virtual Companion.
4. Confirm the service is Active.
5. Answer the required Service Questions: enter the member's best phone number, and confirm the quantity entered reflects the hours allotted for this referral (Yes).
6. Enter the Quantity in hours (1 point each). For Post Discharge, submit the full 20-hour referral in one entry.
7. Select Add to Cart.

CARE SOMEWHERE OTHER THAN THE MEMBER'S HOME ADDRESS?

Before you add the service, select Change Service Address next to “Available Services for…” and enter where care will happen. It applies to this referral only, and the member's address on file doesn't change.

USING BOTH SERVICES?

Add and review each service separately. Search for the second service, repeat the phone number and quantity steps, and add it to the cart before checkout. The 20 hours are one shared allotment — split them across the two referrals so they add up to 20, not 20 on each.

Worked example

SERVICE	QUANTITY	POINTS EACH	TOTAL POINTS
Post Discharge	16	1.00	16.00
Virtual Companion	4	1.00	4.00
Total Points			**20.00**

Review and submit

1. On the Referrals Summary screen, review each service's quantity and total points — use + or − to adjust a quantity if you need to.
2. Confirm the Service Address. If it isn't right, go back to the previous screen and use Change Service Address before you check out.
3. Check that the combined total matches the member's allotment.
4. Select Checkout, then Confirm.

VERIFY THE SERVICE ADDRESS BEFORE YOU CHECK OUT

An incorrect address can't be edited after checkout — it takes a Zendesk ticket to close the referral, and you'll have to create a brand-new one. Double-check it every time — and if it's wrong, go back to the previous screen and change it before you select Checkout.

AFTER SUBMITTING

The referral may not show an encounter right away — encounters only appear once the provider has actioned the referral. That's expected, not an error.